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Cambridge International Education

Cambridge IGCSE™

CANDIDATE NAME	
CENTRE NUMBER	
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FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH **0500/01**

Paper 1 Reading **For examination from 2027**

CONVERTED PAPER **2 hours**

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **all** questions.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen. Do **not** use correction fluid or tape.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [ ].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has 14 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

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Read **Text A**, ***What are earthscrapers?***, in the insert and then answer **Question 1(a)–(e)**.

Question 1

(a) What is the name of the type of building that is built a long distance downwards into the ground?

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..... [1]

(b) **Using your own words**, explain what the text means by:

(i) 'impressive distance' (line 4)

.....

..... [2]

(ii) 'countless structures' (line 5).

.....

..... [2]

(c) Re-read paragraph 2 ('Countless structures ... architectural plans.').

(i) Give **two** reasons why an underground car park could not be described as an 'earthscraper'.

- .....
- ..... [2]

(ii) Explain the effect of the word 'wondrous' (line 7).

.....

.....

..... [2]

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(d) Re-read paragraphs 3 and 4 ('One proposal ... the project.').

(i) Give **two** ways in which Mexico City might benefit if an earthscraper was built.

- .....
- ..... [2]

(ii) **Using your own words**, explain why the writer describes the Mexican proposal as 'ambitious' (line 11).

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..... [3]

(iii) Explain why building the Mexico City earthscraper could be seen as problematic.

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..... [3]

(e) Re-read paragraph 5 ('There are mixed feelings ... to consider too.').

Using your own words, explain why some people might be against earthscrapers.

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..... [3]

[Total: 20]

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Read **Text B**, ***Buying an underground house***, in the insert and then answer **Question 2(a)** and **2(b)**.

Question 2

(a) According to Text B, in what ways can someone buying and living in their first underground home ensure that it is a positive experience?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 5 marks for writing.

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(b) Assess the writer's attitude towards living underground.

Use **three** details from Text B to support your answer.

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[Total: 20]

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Read **Text C**, ***Visiting Underground City***, in the insert and then answer **Question 3(a)–(d)**.

Question 3

(a) **Identify a word or phrase from the text** which suggests the same idea as the **words in bold**:

(i) Underground City appears **awe-inspiring** on the narrator's phone.

..... [1]

(ii) Before they enter the chamber, the visitors have to **lean forwards and lower their heads**.

..... [1]

(b) **Using your own words**, explain what the writer means by each of the **words in bold**:

Milo is waiting for us to gather round him. He smiles **expansively** and **beckons** us closer. His eyes **pick out** Ben and a young girl, the only two children present.

(i) expansively ..... [1]

(ii) beckons ..... [1]

(iii) pick out ..... [1]

(c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer uses language to suggest Simon's thoughts and feelings on the journey back to the hotel.

Use your own words in your explanation.

I notice how the volcanic rock and soil that had made burrowing underground so easy once means that this is not a land of fertile forests. A handful of lonely broken trees wither in the dry flat land as far as the eye can see. An evening walk to see this open landscape under a vast sky is a tempting idea. My camera would capture some spectacular panoramic vistas. Meanwhile, Milo is telling us about a must-visit outdoor market selling local crafts. Not my favourite thing to do ...

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..... [5]

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(d) Choose **three** powerful words or phrases from the extract below to analyse how the writer uses language to describe the heat in Tassos.

Jodie was right about the heat outside. The sun had been unrelenting since our arrival, but fortunately, most of Tassos is within a short distance of the coast. On our morning beach visits, fresh breezes whipped the heaviness out of the air, while fun in the sea energised us. But now, sitting in the still courtyard of our hotel, everywhere was parched and begged for hydration. In front of me a dying tree had collapsed, its trunk riven at the base. Oddly, its spindly uppermost branches still stretched skyward, while its lower boughs wept dry tears into the cracked earth.

Write about 200 to 250 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer.

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Re-read **Text C**, ***Visiting Underground City***, in the insert and then answer **Question 4**.

Question 4

You are Jodie. After your holiday to Tassos, your friend asks you whether you would recommend Tassos as a holiday destination for them and their young children.

Write a letter to your friend in which you:

- describe the area of Tassos and give your thoughts about it
- explain why you visited Underground City and give your thoughts about the experience
- describe what else there is to do in Tassos and give your advice about the best ways to make sure that the holiday is enjoyed by the whole family.

Write about 250 to 300 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 10 marks for writing.

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[Total: 20]

Additional page

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